

NAIF: Responsible Research Assessment and Metadata Quality for Interoperable Research Infrastructures in Switzerland

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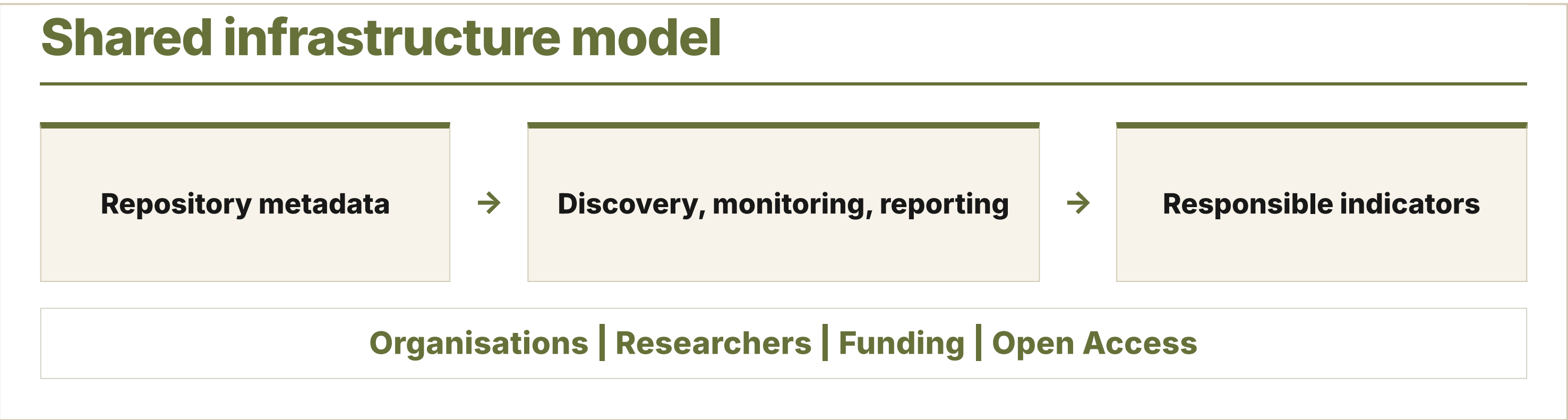
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Overview

NAIF (National Approach for Interoperable Repositories and Findable Research Results) is a swissuniversities co-funded collaboration between eight Swiss higher education institutions that strengthens interoperability and metadata quality across Swiss institutional repositories.

Responsible indicators and interoperable repositories require the same curated metadata foundation.

Fragmented repository practices make national discovery, monitoring, and analysis difficult. This poster connects **Track 1** on responsible research assessment with **Track 4** on academic metadata quality to show why assessment reform and repository interoperability should be treated as one shared infrastructure problem.



Evidence base

Track 1: Responsible assessment

- Workshop with **27 stakeholders** from Swiss higher education institutions, policy bodies, and the wider scientometrics community.
- Discussion of current indicator use, implementation barriers, and institutional needs.
- Framed by **DORA**, **CoARA**, and the **Leiden Manifesto**.

Track 4: Metadata quality

- Workshops with repository managers, data stewards, and open science specialists from across Switzerland.
- Focus on organisational, researcher, funding, and Open Access metadata.
- Prioritisation of practical actions for curation, workflows, and cross-institution coordination.

Key messages

Aspect	Insight
Reform momentum	Swiss institutions increasingly align with DORA and CoARA, but implementation remains uneven.
Responsible indicators	Quantitative indicators must be transparent, contextual, and fair.
Preferred use	Organisational monitoring is generally more appropriate than individual benchmarking.
Metadata priorities	ROR and ORCID alignment, funding metadata, and Open Access metadata are the most actionable improvement areas.

Next steps

Qualitative survey with research assessment and repository actors to map practices, expectations, and tensions around indicator use and metadata workflows.

By the end of 2026, NAIF will deliver practical guidance and governance proposals for Swiss repository interoperability.

Contact

NAIF Tracks 1 and 4
Responsible research assessment and academic metadata
<naif@library.ethz.ch> | <<https://eth-library.github.io/naif/>>

Consortium and funder



Q1: Why connect assessment and metadata?

- Repositories increasingly support **discovery**, **open science monitoring**, **policy reporting**, and **evaluation practices**.
- Incomplete or inconsistent records reduce findability and weaken interpretation.
- Metadata quality is therefore not only a technical issue; it is a precondition for **responsible research assessment**.

Q2: Which metadata families matter most?

Organisations

Disambiguate institutions and units, support aggregation, and improve cross-system linking.

Researchers

Connect outputs reliably to people and reduce ambiguity in authorship data.

Funding

Link outputs to grants and programmes, making public investment more visible and interpretable.

Open Access

Clarify dissemination routes, access conditions, and monitoring categories.

These four families provide the **contextual backbone** for repositories, discovery services, and assessment workflows.

Q3: What did Swiss stakeholders emphasise?

- Indicators must be **transparent**, **context-specific**, and **fair**.
- Quantitative metrics should **complement expert judgement**, not replace it.
- Organisational monitoring** is generally preferable to individual performance ranking.
- Data quality is non-negotiable**: source transparency, documentation, and curation are prerequisites for meaningful indicators.
- Academic libraries are central because they maintain trusted metadata and document its limits.

Q4: What can academic libraries do now?

- Improve institutional name disambiguation and **ROR** alignment.
- Strengthen **ORCID** integration in repository and CRIS workflows.
- Standardise the capture of **funding** and **Open Access** metadata at deposit stage.
- Maintain shared mappings for organisational hierarchies and local structures.
- Connect metadata curation more closely with local assessment and reporting needs.

Conclusion and key takeaways

NAIF treats metadata stewardship and responsible indicators as one shared infrastructure challenge. Better organisational, researcher, funding, and Open Access metadata improve discovery, support transparent monitoring, and make evaluation more fair, transparent, and interpretable.

1 Libraries curate infrastructure for both visibility and assessment.

2 Responsible indicators depend on trustworthy metadata.

3 Four metadata families provide essential context.

4 Shared governance through a national working group can sustain quality beyond the project period.